

do not have decimal places. When a calculation includes a number with decimal places, the computer treats it as a floating point number. Earlier computers used to have a separate processor to handle floating point calculations, but nowadays, this ability is integrated with the CPU.

6.3.15 IDE

Integrated Development Environment. Most programming languages have a text editor that will highlight the source code based on the syntax for the language, a compiler that will compile the software program for execution by the computer, and a debugger to debug the source code. In many instances, the three programs are separate from each other, and a software developer would need to open each program to accomplish the associated task. An IDE gives the developer a single development environment with the editor, compiler, and debugger built into a single software system. In addition, depending on the compiler, it may support more than one programming language, and also allow the developer to use visual development tools especially for user interface development. Examples of IDEs are Visual Studio and Eclipse.

6.3.16 Integer

One of the most commonly-used data types, integers are whole numbers that can be positive, negative, or zero. Integers are not fractions or decimal numbers. Thus if the result of dividing two integers produces a non-integer result, then the decimal numbers may either be rounded or truncated to produce the integer result.

6.3.17 Java

A step up from C and C++, Java is the programming language of choice for many Web and software developers. Very similar to C and C++ in its syntax, it is object oriented but structured around “classes” instead of “functions.” To quote Sun Microsystems, the developers of the Java language,

